About the Author

M Laxmikanth obtained his postgraduate degree in Political Science from Osmania University in 1989. He is the former founder and director of an erstwhile coaching institute called Laxmikanth's IAS Academy, Hyderabad. Other books authored by him include *Governance in India, Objective Indian Polity and Public Administration*.

Preface to the Eighth Edition

Iam pleased to announce the release of the latest edition of Indian Polity, now structured as a comprehensive courseware. This edition features two new chapters on North Eastern Council and Judgements Expanding the Scope of Article 21, over 40 Conceptual Videos, Preliminary questions for 2024–2025 with answer keys, and Main questions for 2023-2024—making it both timely and highly relevant for aspirants.

Recognising that videos are now an integral part of the learning journey, we've included in-depth videos on complex topics to help learners gain a clearer and deeper understanding of key concepts in Polity.

With these enhancements, I firmly believe this edition stands as a thoroughly updated and holistic manual for civil services preparation. It is a matter of immense satisfaction that the previous seven editions have received an overwhelmingly positive response from readers, and I am confident that this edition will continue to earn your trust and support.

As always, constructive feedback and specific suggestions for improvement are most welcome and will be sincerely appreciated.

M Laxmikanth

Preface to the First Edition

I have great pleasure in placing this book before the aspirants of the top administrative services. The book has been written to meet the growing requirements of the candidates appearing for the Civil Services Examinations (Preliminary and Main) conducted by the Union Public Service Commission. It directly and fully covers the Indian Polity section of the paper on General Studies and is also useful for certain optional subjects like Public Administration, Political Science, Law, Sociology and Anthropology.

This comprehensive volume would enable the readers to acquire a complete and detailed understanding of the subject. It covers all dimensions (constitutional, non-constitutional, political and administrative) of the subject. My first-hand experience of coaching the candidates for the Civil Services Examinations has been a great source of inspiration and has helped me immensely in writing this book.

An effort has been made to make the contents of the book relevant, authentic, and up-to-date. The constitutional provisions are explained in the light of the debates of the Constituent Assembly of India as well as the judgements of the Supreme Court and the high courts. I have also used tables to make the presentation more clear. The Appendices, provided at the end of the book, serve as a reference section.

I welcome all constructive comments and concrete suggestions from the readers of this book.

M Laxmikanth

Acknowledgements